

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1557

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the 100th anniversary of
Rhodes College in Memphis.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize and commend those institutions that have made lasting contributions to the educational, cultural, and civic life of this State; and

WHEREAS, Rhodes College traces its origins to the mid-1830s, when it was established as the all-male Montgomery Academy in Clarksville; and

WHEREAS, in 1848, the Tennessee General Assembly authorized the academy's property for the establishment of the Masonic University of Tennessee; in 1855, the institution came under the auspices of the Presbyterian Church and was renamed Stewart College in honor of its president, William M. Stewart; and

WHEREAS, during the Civil War, the college's buildings served as headquarters for the Union Army, and in the years that followed, the institution worked to recover from the damage sustained to its campus and surrounding community; and

WHEREAS, in 1875, the college was renamed Southwestern Presbyterian University, and in the early twentieth century, under the leadership of Charles E. Diehl, significant reforms were implemented, including the admission of women in 1917, the establishment of an honor code in 1918, and the recruitment of Oxford-trained scholars to lead the implementation of an Oxford-Cambridge style of education; and

WHEREAS, in 1925, the institution relocated from Clarksville to Memphis, marking a transformative moment in its history and establishing its enduring presence in the City of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, in 1945, the institution adopted the name Southwestern at Memphis, and in 1948, Peyton N. Rhodes was selected as president, guiding the college through a period of growth that included the construction of new facilities and the admission of its first Black students; and

WHEREAS, in 1984, the board of trustees renamed the institution Rhodes College in honor of President Rhodes, recognizing his more than fifty years of dedicated service; and

WHEREAS, Rhodes College has since grown into a nationally recognized liberal arts and sciences institution, offering a wide range of academic programs and providing generations of students with a strong foundation in scholarship, leadership, and service; and

WHEREAS, the college has been recognized among the nation's leading liberal arts institutions, including designation as one of the top fifty-five liberal arts universities by *U.S. News & World Report* and among the top twenty colleges in the South by *Forbes*; and

WHEREAS, the 100th anniversary of Rhodes College's relocation to Memphis provides an opportunity to reflect upon its rich history and its continuing contributions to the State of Tennessee and beyond; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commemorate the 100th anniversary of Rhodes College in Memphis, honoring its long-standing commitment to academic excellence and its enduring contributions to the citizens of this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.